How-To Library

Informatica

How to Find Critical Assets Using Custom Attributes in Enterprise Data Catalog

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Abstract

This article describes how you can find critical assets by annotating the assets with custom attributes in Enterprise Data Catalog.

Supported Versions

- Informatica Enterprise Data Catalog 10.4.1

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Overview

You can use custom attributes to annotate assets so that you can quickly find specific assets in Enterprise Data Catalog.

You can assign a custom attribute value to an asset to append additional information to the asset. You can search for assets using custom attribute values to increase your productivity by reducing the time to create multiple search filters to search for specific assets.

Tutorial Example

You are a data architect in a financial institution, and you must make sure that there are no data violations in the institution. You must annotate assets that have data violations as Non-compliant. You must then report the Non-compliant assets to the IT team for them to take the required action.

You searched several datasets and identified that a resource named **Oracle_finance** includes assets that are not compliant for data privacy policy. To find the non-compliant assets faster in the Catalog, you create a custom attribute named **Non-Compliance** and assign the **Non-compliant asset** custom attribute value to all the assets in the resource. Now, you find the non-compliant assets faster using the custom attribute value without having to search millions of datasets again in the Catalog.

In this tutorial, you complete the following lessons on creating and using custom attributes:

Create a custom attribute.

You create a custom attribute of string data type called **Non-compliance** in Catalog Administrator.

Assign custom attribute value to assets in a resource.

You assign a custom attribute value called **Non-compliant asset** to all the assets in the resource in Catalog Administrator.

Add and configure custom attribute.

You add and configure the **Non-compliance** custom attribute that you created on the **Application Configuration** page in Enterprise Data Catalog application.

Assign custom attribute value to a specific asset.

You assign the **Compliant asset** custom attribute value to a specific asset in Enterprise Data Catalog application.

Search for assets that have assigned custom attribute value.

You use the search box to find all the assets that are associated with **Non-compliant asset** custom attribute value in Enterprise Data Catalog application.

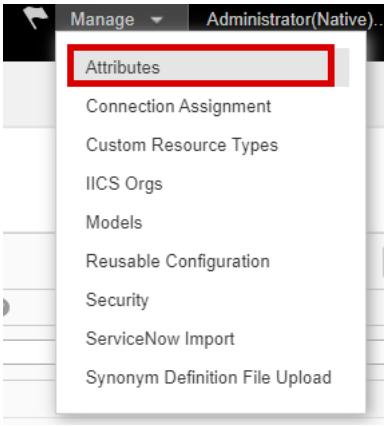
Lesson 1: Create a Custom Attribute

You can choose to create custom attributes of different data types, such as String, Decimal, Integer, Date, and Boolean, or extended data types, such as User.

In this lesson, you will create a custom attribute named **Non-Compliance** of string data type so that we can assign the custom attribute to assets in a resource that contains sensitive information.

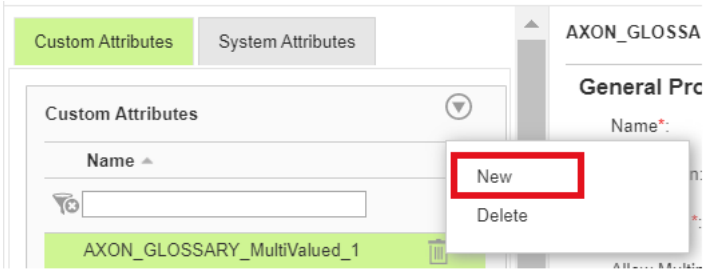
To create custom attributes in Catalog Administrator, perform the following steps:

1. Log in to the Catalog Administrator.
2. Click **Manage** > **Attributes**.



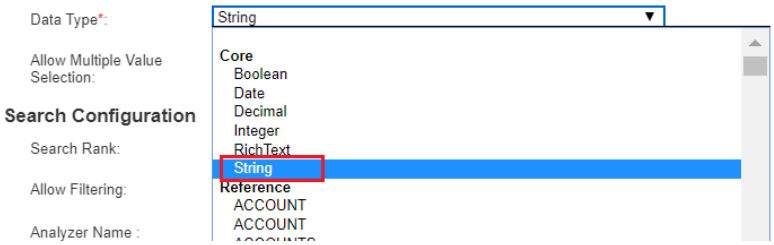
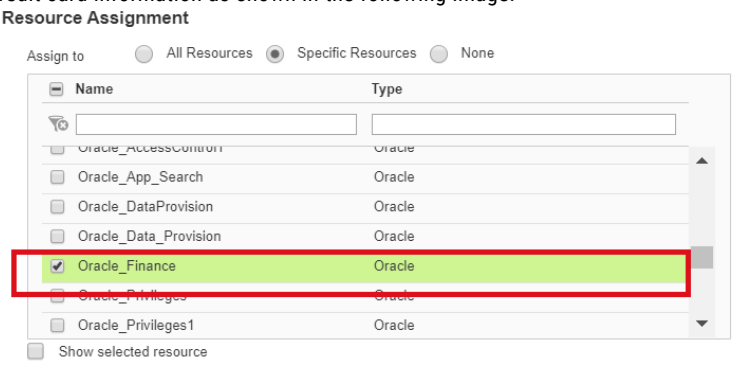
The **Attributes** workspace appears.

3. From the **Actions** menu, select **New**.



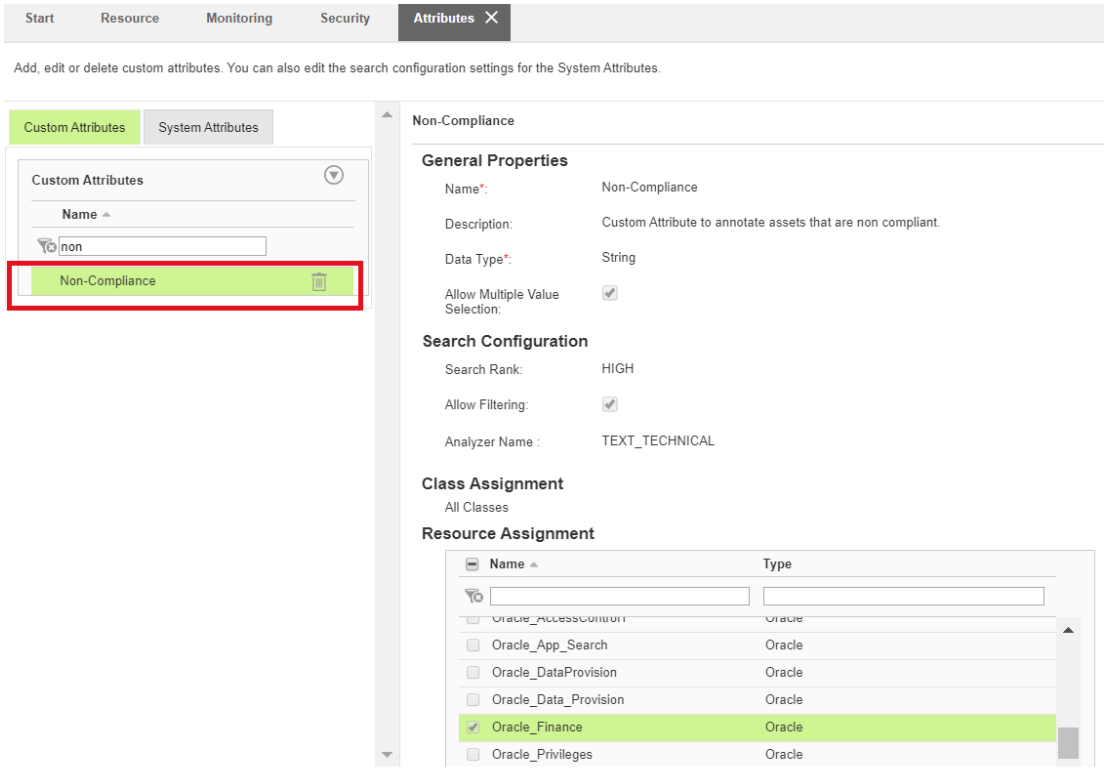
The **New Custom Attribute** dialog box appears.

4. Enter the following custom attribute details:

Option	Value
Name	`Non-compliance`
Description	`Annotation of assets that are non-compliant.`
Data Type	`String` The data type determines the valid type of values for the custom attribute. The following image shows the data types that you can use to create custom attributes: 
Allow Multiple Value Selection	`True` Allows you to enter multiple attribute values for a custom attribute.
Search Rank	`High`
Allow Filtering	`True` Allows you to display the custom attribute as a search filter in the Catalog.
Analyzer Name	`TEXT_TECHNICAL`
Class Assignment	`All Classes`
Resource Assignment	`Specific Resources` In this tutorial, you will the select Oracle_Finance resource as it contains assets with credit card information as shown in the following image: 

5. Click **OK** to save the custom attribute.

After you save the custom attribute, the **Non-Compliance** custom attribute appears in the **Custom Attributes** panel as shown in the following image:

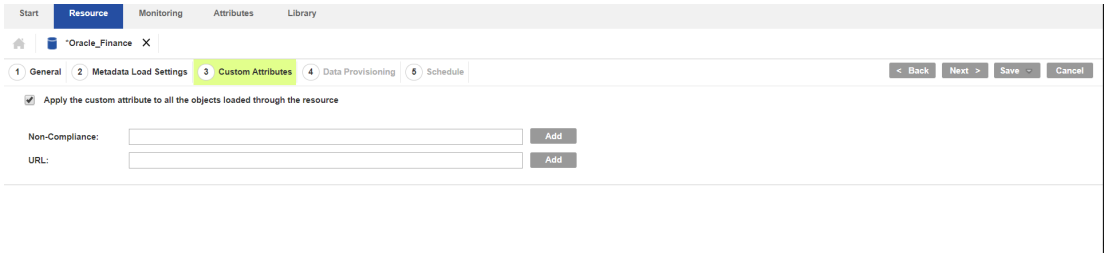


Lesson 2: Assign a Custom Attribute Value to all the Assets in a Resource

You can assign a custom attribute value to all the assets when you create and configure a resource.

In this lesson, you will assign the **non-compliant asset** custom attribute value to the **Oracle_Finance** resource in Catalog Administrator.

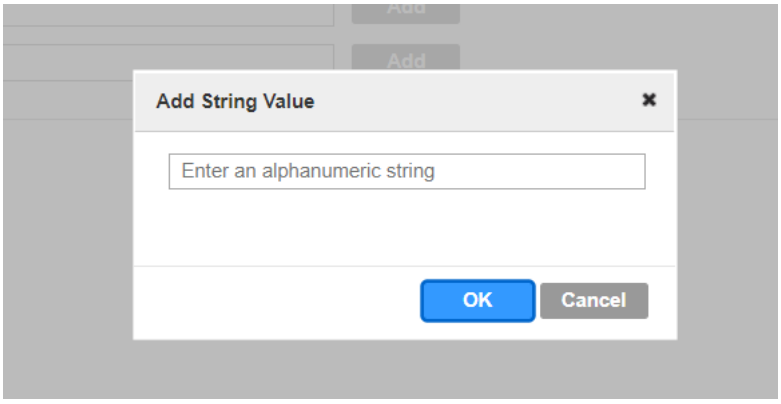
You identified that a resource named **Oracle_Finance** contains credit card information. The **Oracle_Finance** resource is selected, and the **Custom Attributes** page is open as shown in the following image:



To assign the custom attribute value to all the assets in the **Oracle_Finance** resource, perform the following steps:

1. In the Custom Attributes page, select **Non-Compliance** custom attribute, and then click **Add**.

   The **Add String Value** dialog box appears.



2. Enter the `non-compliant asset` as the custom attribute value.

   You can choose to apply the custom attribute value to all the assets loaded through the resource.

3. To apply the custom attribute value to all the assets in the resource, check the **Apply the custom attribute to all the objects loaded through the resource** option.

4. Click **Save and Run**.

Lesson 3: Add a Custom Attribute in Enterprise Data Catalog

After you create a custom attribute in Catalog Administrator, you must add the custom attribute to the **Custom Attributes** tab of the **Application Configuration** page. The Custom Attributes tab helps you configure the custom attributes that you want to display as search filters. Use the configured custom attributes to refine the search.

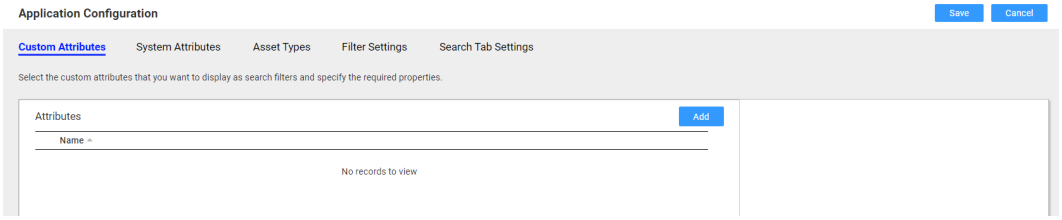
In this lesson, you will learn how to add the **Non-Compliance** custom attribute to the Catalog.

To create custom attributes in Catalog Administrator, perform the following steps:

1. Log in to Enterprise Data Catalog.

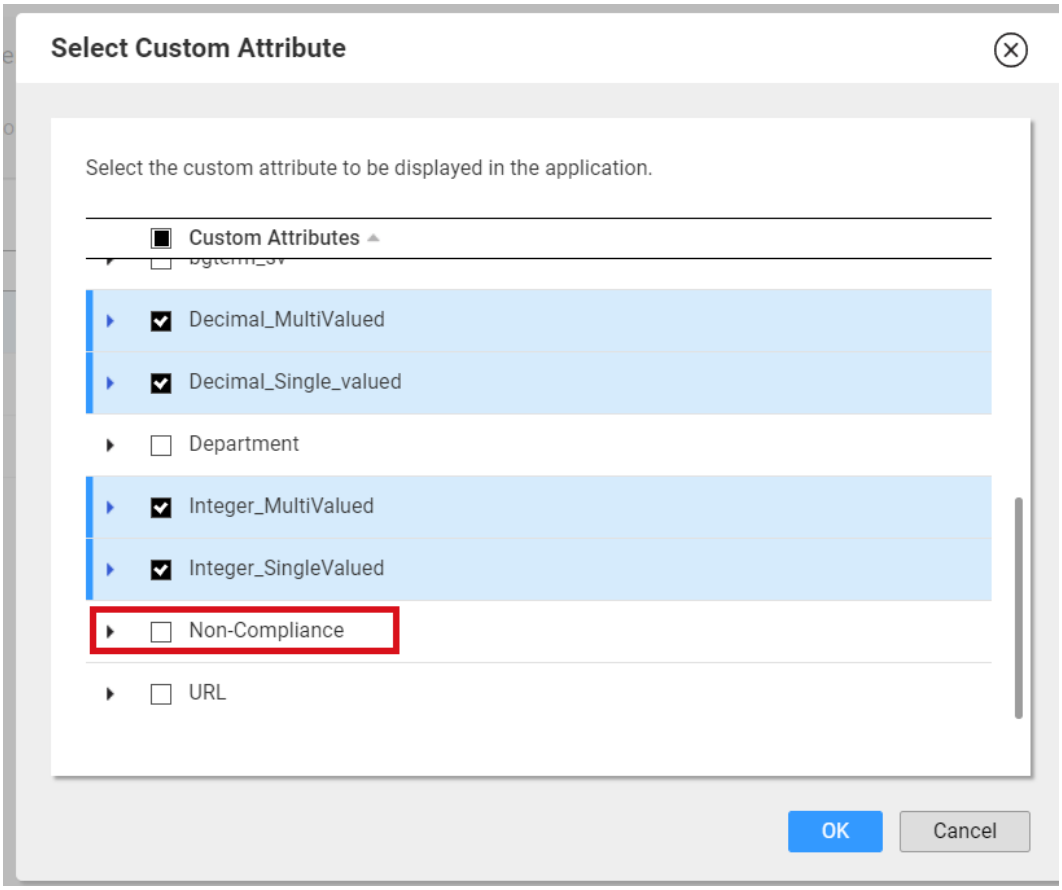
2. Click the Application Configuration Settings icon in the Enterprise Data Catalog header.

   The **Application Configuration** page appears as shown in the following image:



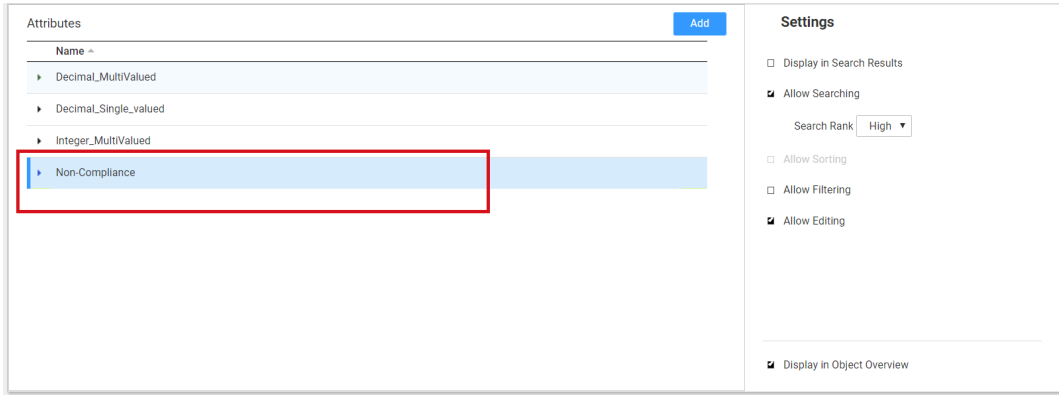
3. In the **Custom Attributes** tab, click **Add.**

The **Select Custom Attributes** dialog box appears as shown in the following image:



4. Select **Non-Compliance** custom attribute, and click **OK**.

   After you add the custom attribute, the custom attribute appears in the attributes list as shown in the following image:



5. Additionally, you can configure the custom attribute settings to display the custom attribute value in the search results, search for assets using the custom attribute, and filter assets using the custom attribute.
6. Click **Save**.

Lesson 4: Assign a Custom Attribute Value to a Specific Asset

Additionally, you can choose to assign a custom attribute value to a specific asset in the catalog.

In this lesson, you will learn how to assign a custom attribute value to a specific asset on the Overview tab.

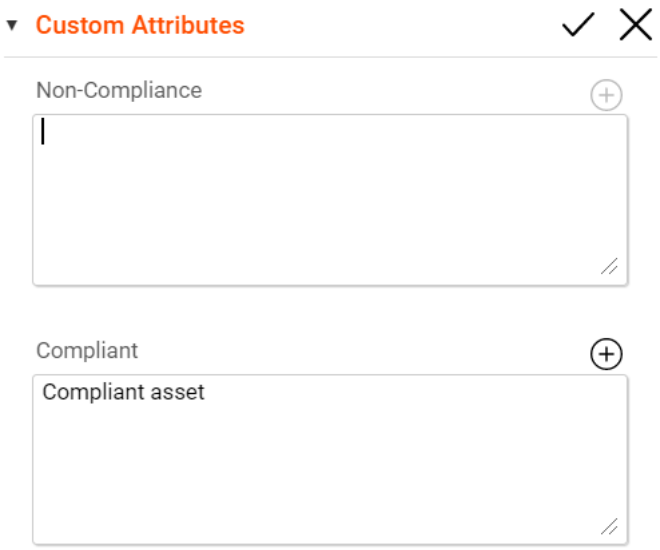
You found out that one of the assets named **CIP** is incorrectly tagged as non-compliant, so you want to remove the custom attribute value and assign a new custom attribute value called **compliant asset** manually.

To remove and assign a custom attribute value manually, perform the following steps:

1. On the **Overview** tab of the asset, click the edit properties icon from the custom attributes section.
2. To remove the custom attribute value, clear the custom attribute value, and then click the save icon.

   In this example, you delete the **non-compliant asset** custom attribute value from the asset.
3. To add the custom attribute value, enter the custom attribute value in the field, and then click the save icon.

   In this example, you add **Compliant asset** as the custom attribute value to the asset as shown in the following image:



Lesson 5: Search for Assets Using Custom Attributes

You can search for a custom attribute value to find assets that have the custom attribute assigned on the search results page.

In this lesson, you will learn how to find assets using the custom attribute value.

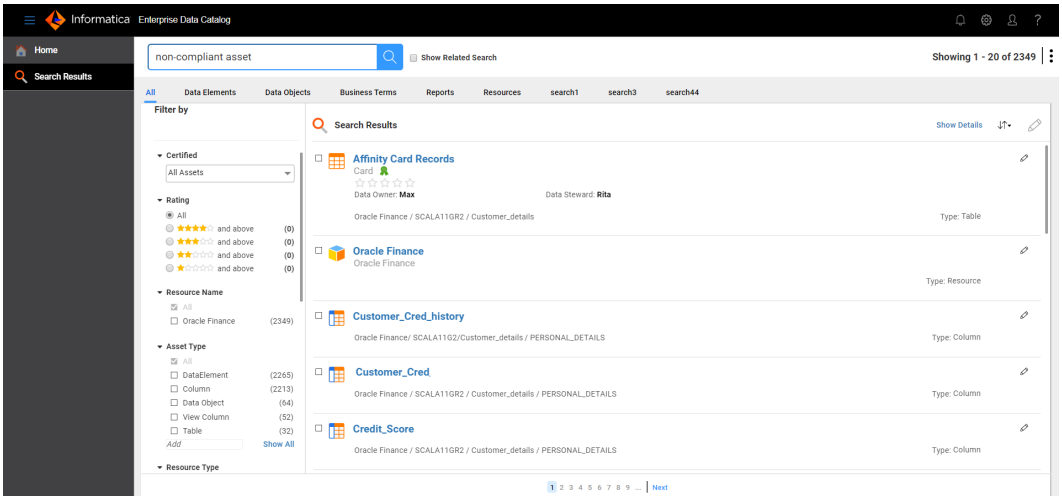
You added the custom attribute and assigned custom attribute value to assets in the catalog. Now, you can search for the assets containing credit card details of customers using the **non-compliant asset** custom attribute value in the search box.

To view the assets containing credit card details of customers, perform the following steps:

1. In the search box, type **non-compliant asset**.

2. Click the search icon.

   The search results page displays assets that have the **non-compliant asset** custom attribute value assigned.



After you find the assets that are not compliant, you can report the assets to the IT team so that the team can take the necessary action.

Author

Sabha S